



INTERVIEW

Serie „Kollege KI“

Nach Rausch und Euphorie folgt bei Unternehmen der „KI-Kater“

Von Thorsten Breitkopf

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INTERVIEW · SERIE KOLLEGE KI

An AI *hangover*

that many companies are only now noticing

THE FIRST QUESTION

Which jobs will be affected by AI?

AI changes activities long before it changes whole professions.

- Routine, predictable, data-driven work moves first. Bookkeeping, parts of software development, translation.
- Entry-level roles are under the most pressure, and that is where people learn their craft.
- What stays needs empathy, human interaction, physical skill and strategic thinking.

Some roles will change substantially, and the people who learn to work with AI well will be in the stronger position.

THE KI-KATER

Nach Rausch und Euphorie folgt der Kater.

After the rush and the euphoria comes the hangover.

- The rush was real. Capable models arrived fast and the productivity promise was credible.
- Then everyone jumped on the bandwagon, many of them out of fear of missing the party.
- A bit like ordering one more beer at the Oktoberfest because your friends are doing the same.

Now the results are in.

WHERE PROJECTS FAIL

It is rarely the model that fails. It is everything around it.

Usage is billed in tokens, the units a text is broken into before a model can process it, and enthusiastic use adds up. The larger costs sit elsewhere. In our Pulse research, executives name the same three obstacles as the biggest barriers to scaling AI:

- 53%** Reliability and accuracy of outputs. Every wrong answer is repaired by a person downstream.
- 50%** Integration with existing tech and IT systems.
- 47%** Data quality and availability.

A service assistant that resolves nine cases and mishandles the tenth can consume the savings from all nine.

15%

believe AI can replace the creativity and problem-solving of human engineers

84%

are increasing AI investment anyway, with over 75% expecting improvements of 20 to 50% in productivity, time to market and cost

Both are correct. The money is going into augmenting engineers, not replacing them, and that is a much harder thing to implement well.

Capgemini Research Institute, 1,500 executives at organisations above \$1bn revenue, surveyed August 2025.

WHY IT STALLS

Value does not arrive with access to a model.

It arrives through governance, process integration, and people who know what they are doing.

AI adoption at scale is not mainly a technology problem. It is an organisational and a very human one.

THE TAKEAWAY

AI is not a replacement for our own thinking.

It is a multiplier for those who think clearly and have the discipline to use it properly. The organisations getting real value are the ones whose people still ask what the model is doing and where it is likely to be wrong.

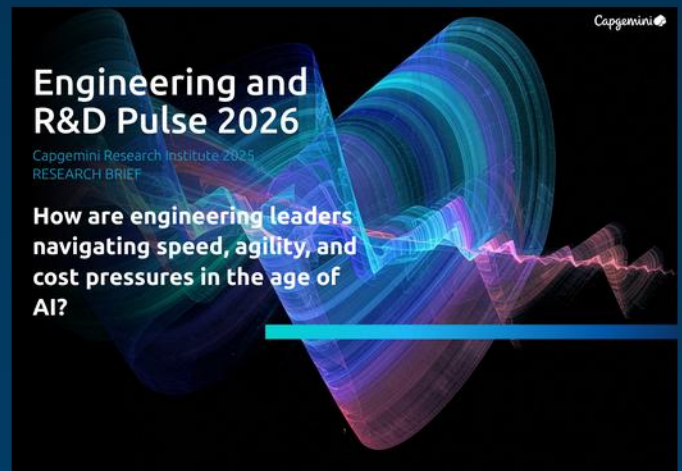
Critical thinking has rarely been as valuable as it is now, and no model will do it for us.

MORE IN THE FULL PIECE

The interview goes further than this carousel.



KÖLNER STADT-ANZEIGER
Print, 4 August 2026. Also in Kölnische
Rundschau, Bonner Rundschau and
other group titles.



ENGINEERING & R&D PULSE 2026
Capgemini Research Institute, 1,500
executives, August 2025.

Also in the interview: the race between America and China, open weight models and what they mean for European independence, and what Europe should do now.

Full interview linked in the post. The Capgemini research is linked in the comments. 8/8